

Test 2

READING AND USE OF ENGLISH (1 hour 15 minutes)

Part 1

For questions 1–8, read the text below and decide which answer (A, B, C or D) best fits each gap. There is an example at the beginning (0).

Mark your answers on the separate answer sheet.

Example:

0 A appear B show C prove D seem

0	A o	B ●	C o	D o
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Parrot intelligence

Keas are the world's only mountain parrots and are among the most intelligent birds, although they (0) no fear of humans. They also have a (1) for being thieves and playing tricks. Now researchers have found that they can (2) up probabilities, using several sources of information to help them make choices. In an experiment where they were (3) with the opportunity to earn food rewards, the birds were able to figure out which option had the highest (4) of providing a reward.

Humans and great apes such as gorillas are known to (5) a lot of different types of information to make a single judgement or decision, whereas most animals are believed to use only one source of information at a (6) However, recent research offers the first clear (7) that other animals can also put pieces of information together. The new findings (8) with the traditional idea that animals have only become 'clever' at tasks they need in order to survive.

- | | | | | |
|---|--------------------|----------------------|--------------------|---------------------|
| 1 | A summary | B description | C fame | D reputation |
| 2 | A look | B weigh | C keep | D hold |
| 3 | A presented | B offered | C proposed | D given |
| 4 | A occasion | B chance | C luck | D risk |
| 5 | A cooperate | B coincide | C combine | D cross |
| 6 | A point | B stage | C time | D phase |
| 7 | A evidence | B knowledge | C awareness | D witness |
| 8 | A differ | B conflict | C deny | D challenge |

Part 2

For questions 9–16, read the text below and think of the word which best fits each gap. Use only **one** word in each gap. There is an example at the beginning (0).

Write your answers **IN CAPITAL LETTERS** on the separate answer sheet.

Example:

0

A	S																
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Good Energy

Climate change (0) a subject wasn't headline news in the 1990s. The general public was only gradually becoming aware of the issue. Like many scientists, Juliet Davenport, a physicist (9) special interest is the study of the atmosphere, (10) already realised that action was needed.

Juliet researched green energy sources and could see (11) needed to be done in order to bring about change. She set up a company that would provide its customers with energy from renewable sources. In (12) words, it offered them the chance to be part of the solution (13) than adding to the problem.

The idea behind the company, (14) Juliet called *Good Energy*, arose because families were installing solar panels on the roofs of their houses. In many cases, (15) more energy would be produced than the family needed, they had no way of selling that surplus to others. By providing a way of collecting this extra energy and selling it on, the company were putting themselves (16) a position to help both producers and consumers of green energy.

Part 3

For questions 17–24, read the text below. Use the word given in capitals at the end of some of the lines to form a word that fits in the gap **in the same line**. There is an example at the beginning (0).

Write your answers **IN CAPITAL LETTERS** on the separate answer sheet.

Example:

0

D	E	L	I	B	E	R	A	T	E	L	Y						
---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	---	--	--	--	--	--	--

Strange plant behaviour

Are plants capable of (0) changing colour? Until recently, most people would have thought this was (17)
However, evidence suggests it is possible in certain species as a (18) to a threat in their local environment.

DELIBERATE**LIKE****RESPOND**

The *fritillaria delavayi* plant has grown in the mountains in China for thousands of years. It's easy to spot, producing a bright green flower which is used for (19) purposes, and is currently much in demand.

MEDICINE

Recently, however, the plant seemed to disappear from its mountain habitat and couldn't be found anywhere. In fact, it was still thriving, but its leaves had changed colour, matching the nearby rocks, and making it almost (20)

VISIBLE

(21) working on this assumed the plant had changed colour to avoid being eaten by animals. However, in the (22) where it grew, no animals threatened its (23) So it may have changed to avoid being picked, in which case it's an example of a (24) remarkable phenomenon in the plant world.

SCIENCE**LOCATE****SURVIVE****TRUE**

Test 2

Part 4

For questions **25–30**, complete the second sentence so that it has a similar meaning to the first sentence, using the word given. **Do not change the word given.** You must use between **two** and **five** words, including the word given. Here is an example (0).

Example:

- 0 A very friendly taxi driver drove us into town.

DRIVEN

We a very friendly taxi driver.

The gap can be filled by the words 'were driven into town by', so you write:

Example:

0

WERE DRIVEN INTO TOWN BY

Write **only** the missing words **IN CAPITAL LETTERS** on the separate answer sheet.

- 25 I'm sorry I spent such a long time looking around the town centre.

MUCH

I wish I time looking around the town centre.

- 26 Nowadays many people think shopping is a leisure-time activity.

REGARDED

Nowadays shopping being a leisure-time activity by many people.

- 27 Paul is a good dancer and also a great musician.

DANCE

Not but he's also a great musician.

- 28 Robbie asked Lorna if she'd decided what to wear to the party.

MIND

'Have you what to wear to the party, Lorna?'
asked Robbie.

- 29 I really intended to write to my grandmother, but I was just too busy studying.

ROUND

I was so busy studying that I didn't to my
grandmother.

- 30 'Have you sent in your job application yet, Celine?' asked John.

WHETHER

John asked Celine sent her job application
in yet.

Part 5

You are going to read an article about the benefits of walking. For questions 31–36, choose the answer (A, B, C or D) which you think fits best according to the text.

Mark your answers on the separate answer sheet.

Walking with the Professor

Amy Fleming walks and talks to a brain scientist

Going for a walk with Professor Shane O'Mara is a risky business. The brain scientist is so passionate about walking, and our collective right to go for walks, that he is determined not to let anything make him pause. So much so that he has a habit of darting across busy roads as the traffic lights change. 'One of life's great horrors as you're walking is waiting for permission to cross the street,' he tells me, when we are forced to stop for traffic. I'm not in a position to challenge this. O'Mara speaks not only through personal experience, but from scientific data – walking makes us healthier, happier and brainier.

We are wandering the streets of Dublin discussing O'Mara's new book, *In Praise of Walking*, a tour of what happens in our brains while we walk, but our chat is unpredictable: we seem to be talking about science, nature, architecture and literature. He favours what he calls a 'motor-centric' view of the brain – that it evolved to support movement and, therefore, if we stop moving about, it won't work as well. Walking connects to both of his main interests as a professor of experimental brain research: stress, depression and anxiety; and learning, memory and thought.

I witnessed the brain-healing effects of walking when my partner was recovering from a brain injury. During our evening strolls through east London, what he said started to make more sense and conversation flowed easily. O'Mara nods his head in agreement. 'You're walking rhythmically together,' he says, 'and there are all sorts of rhythms happening in the brain as a result of engaging in that kind of activity, and they're absent when you're sitting.'

Some people, I point out, don't think walking counts as proper exercise. 'This is a terrible mistake,' he says. 'What we need to be is much more generally active.' And often, an hour at the gym without moving much for the rest of the day doesn't cut it. 'What you see if you get people to wear activity monitors is that because they engage in an hour of really intense activity, they engage in much less activity afterwards.'

line 44

When we walk in an urban area, our social brains are working to predict which direction other people will take, to avoid collision. In order to walk and navigate, says O'Mara, the brain flickers between physical spaces, just as our waking minds are often 'flickering between states – thinking about what we have to do tomorrow, plans for next year, engaging in what is called "mental time travel" – and task-focused work. And you need to flicker between these states in order to do creative work.' That's how important associations get made, and this flickering seems to be helped by walking.

And, while my mind has been flickering through the streets of Dublin, says O'Mara, 'You haven't died or fallen over, and you're continuing to breathe. Your heart is booming away. You're putting one foot in front of the other, and we're engaging in this conversation, information exchange.' Plus, I'm checking out the area, admiring the architecture and watching people go about their lives. 'All of this is going on all the time. Robots can't do this. Getting a robot to cross the road is really hard. Whereas for our brains, evolution has been solving this problem, billions of times an hour, for the past 400 million years.'

- 31 When describing her opinion of O'Mara in the first paragraph, what does the writer mention?
- A his cleverness making her nervous
 - B being amused by one of his habits
 - C feeling impressed by his walking speed
 - D being unqualified to question what he claims
- 32 In the second paragraph, we learn that O'Mara
- A is now doing research for a future book.
 - B has views that some find controversial.
 - C constantly changes the topic of conversation.
 - D began walking in order to prove a theory.
- 33 When quoted in the third paragraph, O'Mara is
- A making clear something that people find hard to understand.
 - B correcting a slight mistake in what the writer has said.
 - C giving an explanation that confirms the writer's experience.
 - D providing an example to support a point made earlier.
- 34 What does 'doesn't cut it' mean in line 44?
- A fails to achieve the desired result
 - B is unrealistic for most people
 - C fails to distinguish effectively between two options
 - D doesn't sound very appealing
- 35 The writer learns that trying not to bump into others
- A involves a similar brain activity to using our imagination.
 - B is one of the most difficult daily jobs the brain has to do.
 - C can be compared to daydreaming about the future.
 - D is rather like what happens in the brain just before we wake up.
- 36 In the final paragraph, O'Mara suggests that the act of walking
- A can usually improve people's mood.
 - B encourages people to communicate.
 - C has the potential to be reproduced by technology.
 - D is the result of adaptation over a long period of time.

Part 6

You are going to read a newspaper article about a children's book illustrator. Six sentences have been removed from the article. Choose from the sentences **A–G** the one which fits each gap (37–42). There is one extra sentence which you do not need to use.

Mark your answers on the separate answer sheet.

The work of a children's book illustrator

If you've ever thought about becoming a children's book illustrator, you might have wondered what day-to-day life would be like, and what skills you'd need for the job. In answer to the question, no two days are the same, and some tasks are pretty ordinary.

Many of them are practical. Sometimes I have to cut wood to the right size as backing for my watercolour paper, at which point it helps to know how to use a saw. **37** I might run over to a local farm to capture animals in action, for example. It all helps with the detail.

Some of my work involves drawing people, and I'll look for real-life models to help me. I'll write an advert describing the look I'm after, say, 'seven years old with red hair and preferably a missing tooth!' **38** Unfortunately, some who apply don't have the look I'm after, so I have to be able to turn them down gently. People skills are a must in these scenarios.

There are also times when I'll spend a few hours browsing the shelves and consulting the staff at my local library. **39** It helps to check out the illustrations in other children's books and the librarians always seem to know where the relevant things are.

Then I get down to the challenging, professional parts of the job. **40** I sit around with my forehead screwed up trying to think of a whole bunch of expressions and body shapes and possibilities, showing them to my family to see if clothing styles for each one and sketching out any of them produce the right reaction. Mostly I'm hoping for 'Wow, Dad! That's fabulous!', though I don't always get it.

Another fun part is working out the page designs. I have to choose which parts of the story to focus on in each illustration. Then I use my imagination to add details and scenery. It helps to be good at daydreaming. I work especially hard on giving the pages lots of variety. **41**

Once the paintings are complete, or I'm at least relatively happy with them, off they go to the publishing company. **42** Once I've received the publisher's comments, it's time for the real fun to begin: doing the final illustrations, which involves hours of painting – my very favourite part of the job.

- | | |
|--|---|
| <p>A For example, I might do one with a character close-up and then one with the characters fairly small compared to their surroundings.</p> <p>B While I'm waiting for it to get back to me, I attend to a few everyday tasks, such as ordering paper, paints and brushes, or looking through the next story I've been asked to work on.</p> <p>C Every so often, I'll go out to take photos that I can refer to when drawing.</p> <p>D Once I've had enough responses, I'll sit down and make a selection.</p> | <p>E Developing characters for a new book is one of my favourites, though it isn't always easy.</p> <p>F I like to answer their questions about books I have illustrated and about my life as an illustrator.</p> <p>G This is because I may need to get a few ideas for my paintings: how dragons are depicted, what princesses typically wear, how to prevent monsters from appearing too scary.</p> |
|--|---|

Part 7

You are going to read an article in which four people talk about their favourite outdoor activities. For questions **43–52**, choose from the people (**A–D**). The people may be chosen more than once.

Mark your answers **on the separate answer sheet**.

Which person

resisted pressure from others to give up on a dream?

43

had not anticipated the extent of a challenge?

44

found that preparing for an activity was rewarding in itself?

45

realised that putting in more effort is not always effective?

46

acquired a technique that proved useful in everyday life?

47

felt instantly attracted by the description of an activity?

48

hoped to share the enjoyment of an activity?

49

enjoys telling others about an achievement?

50

initially lacked the confidence to do an activity fully?

51

says a benefit of an activity was not immediately apparent?

52

Active outdoors

Four people talk about their favourite outdoor activities

A Graham – Racing against horses

The Man-versus-Horse Marathon is a remarkable race in a stunning mountain setting which involves running through forests and along rivers, competing against riders on horseback. The extraordinary romance of it grabbed me as soon as I heard about it and I began training for the event immediately. Training programmes are hard to keep up, but is there anything more inspiring than a race against horses through the mountains? By the day of the race, I already felt my life was much the richer as a result of spending all my spare time training in the mountains. Runners get a 15-minute head start for safety reasons, but it's incredibly tough – you cover 35 kilometres with more than 1,200 metres of climbing. By the end, I was utterly exhausted. But I did beat 36 of the 41 horses, and I've never let my friends forget that. Even more enduring than my boasting, however, is my continued passion for mountain running.

B Sarah – Cold-water swimming

I used to do quite a lot of sport until I injured myself. Being a journalist, I rested by doing some reading about exercise. The more extreme it is, I learned, the more feel-good chemicals your brain releases. But I also discovered that extreme exercise doesn't necessarily mean working harder. Outdoor cold-water swimmers, for example, talk a lot about the 'afterglow'. Maybe that's because the dramatic temperature drop makes the experience feel more extreme. To find out, once I'd recovered enough from my injury, I tried leaping into a mountain pool. I scrambled out, struggling for breath; wrong. Then a wonderful rosy glow came over me. I jumped in again. I began regular lake swims. At first the water felt shockingly cold, but as winter progressed, I slowly acclimatised. My body now felt thirsty for the energy cold water gave me. Learning to breathe out and accept the cold has helped me at many other times, too; we often can't change a situation, but can change our reactions to it.

C Hana – Rock climbing

I grew up near mountains. I'd always been in awe of climbers, but never felt brave enough to be one myself. I devoured books about conquering the world's highest peaks instead. Meanwhile, a short drive from my house, less dramatic mountains sat quiet and inviting. In my late teens, I started to make baby steps, teaching myself on indoor climbing walls. One day, I finally tried the real thing. This first outdoor rock climb followed a route less than 20 metres long, but every move felt dangerous, exciting. I remember the smooth rock at the beginning, how it seemed as if my feet had nothing to grip on to. The route was an easy one, ideal for a beginner, but it was still so much harder than I'd thought it would be. I struggled and grumbled. But when I finally pulled myself over the top, breathless and dizzy and battered by the wind, I was hooked.

D Dan – Surfing

Growing up close to the coast, I learned to surf at an early age, and have warm memories of time spent on the beach with the sound of crashing waves and the laughter of my family all around me. I caught my first wave at the age of 12 and vividly remember the exhilarating sensation of 'walking on water'. Surfing was an escape from the world of human expectations and demands. It only became troublesome when my teachers kept insisting that it was merely a hobby and not a career option. But I was determined not to sacrifice my passion for the sea, and put all my energy into building a business around my lifestyle. I opened my own surf school at the age of 21 with the aim of offering anyone the opportunity to experience the sense of tranquillity and momentary happiness that I had become addicted to.

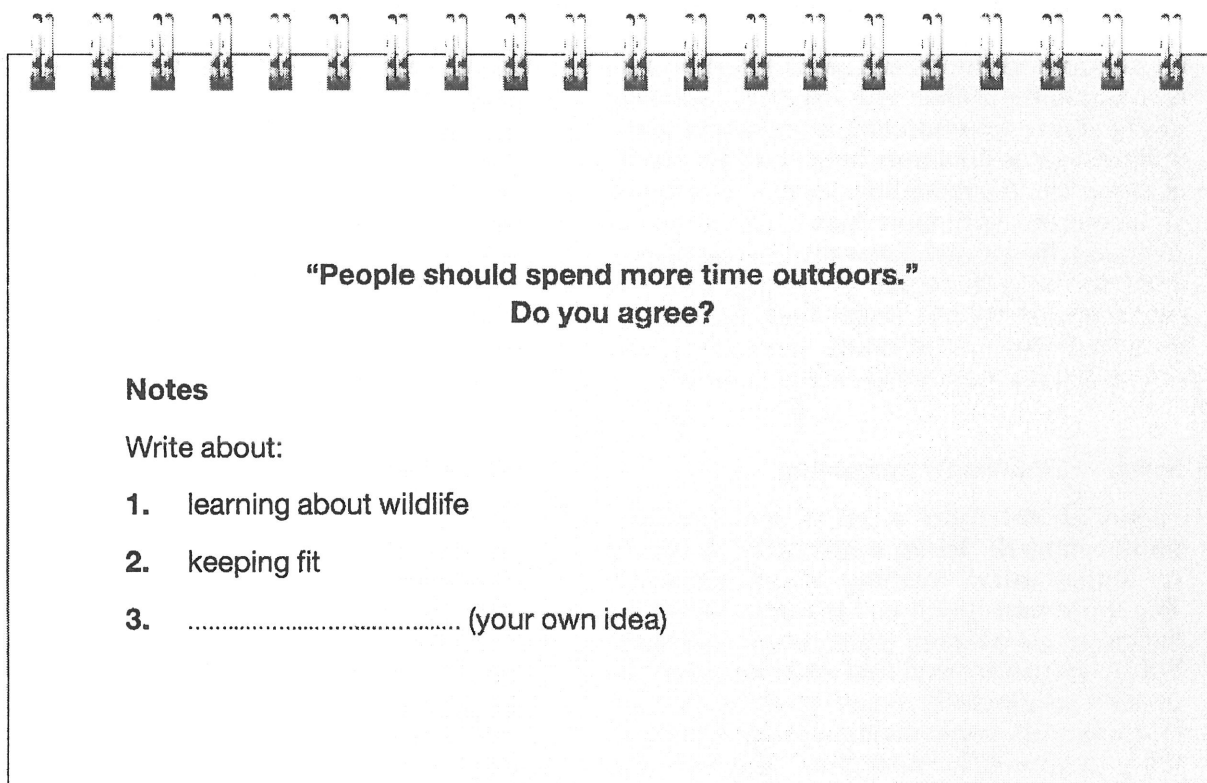
WRITING (1 hour 20 minutes)

Part 1

You **must** answer this question. Write your answer in **140–190** words in an appropriate style on the separate answer sheet.

- 1 In your English class you have been talking about spending time outdoors. Now, your English teacher has asked you to write an essay.

Write your essay using **all** the notes and giving reasons for your point of view.



**"People should spend more time outdoors."
Do you agree?**

Notes

Write about:

1. learning about wildlife
2. keeping fit
3. (your own idea)

Part 2

Write an answer to **one** of the questions **2–4** in this part. Write your answer in **140–190** words in an appropriate style on the separate answer sheet. Put the question number in the box at the top of the answer sheet.

- 2 You see this announcement on an English-language cinema website.

Film reviews wanted

Film about a famous person

Write us a review of a film you've seen about a famous person, either from the past or living today. What did you learn about the person from the film? Would you recommend the film to other people of your age?

The best reviews will be posted on our website.

Write your **review**.

- 3 An English-language newspaper is investigating traffic problems in your local area. You have decided to write a report for the newspaper.

In your report, you should:

- describe the main traffic problems in your area
- explain the effects of these problems
- make recommendations on how to solve these problems.

Write your **report**.

- 4 You see this notice on an English-language website.

Wanted: guides for cycling tours

We organise cycling tours for English-speaking tourists. We are looking for tour guides in your area this summer who:

- are experienced cyclists
- have knowledge of the local area
- enjoy working with people from different countries.

Write to the manager, Ruth Malone, explaining why you would be suitable.

Write your **letter of application**.

Test 2

LISTENING (approximately 40 minutes)

Part 1

You will hear people talking in eight different situations.
For questions **1–8**, choose the best answer (**A**, **B** or **C**).



Listening test audio

- 1** You hear a woman talking to her husband about watching birds in the garden.
What does she like about this?

 - A** knowing that the birds are unaware of her
 - B** watching the process of raising the young ones
 - C** seeing them return to their usual nesting site
- 2** You hear two friends talking about the relationship between music and maths.
What is the woman doing?

 - A** trying to convince the man that she's right
 - B** explaining what she understands
 - C** asking the man for his opinion
- 3** You hear two friends talking about writing short stories.
What do they both find difficult about it?

 - A** getting the story started
 - B** coming up with a suitable ending
 - C** developing interesting characters
- 4** You hear two friends talking about running.
How does the woman feel about it?

 - A** She worries about the risk of injuries.
 - B** She thinks doing it regularly gets boring.
 - C** She prefers doing it in natural surroundings.

- 5 You hear a woman telling her friend about a holiday in the mountains.
What does she say about it?
- A The food was exceptional.
 - B The views were breathtaking.
 - C The accommodation was delightful.
- 6 You hear two friends talking about the discovery of a new organ in the human throat.
What does the man say about it?
- A It was found by chance.
 - B It is incredible that it is so small.
 - C It seems unlikely that anything similar will be found.
- 7 You hear a man telling a friend about a newspaper article he's just read.
What's his attitude towards it?
- A He'd need more evidence before he believes it.
 - B He thinks the journalist may have a point.
 - C He believes there are more interesting things to write about.
- 8 You hear a man talking about surfing.
He says that when he started he was
- A not fit enough to do it properly.
 - B determined not to give up.
 - C surprised at how expensive it was.

Part 2

You will hear a man called Dave Barrett talking on his cycling podcast about a tour he did of Jersey by bike.

For questions 9–18, complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.



A cycling tour of Jersey

Dave's main motivation for the trip was to get away from the

(9) he experiences while he's working.

Arriving on the evening ferry to the island, Dave was impressed by the

(10) he saw.

Dave appreciated listening to the (11)

as he lay in bed on his first night.

Dave was relieved that the (12)

he'd expected didn't happen.

On his first morning, Dave was pleasantly surprised by all the

(13) on the routes he followed.

Cycling close to the beach, Dave wished he had noticed the damage to the

(14) on his bike.

Dave's attention was so taken by a (15)

that he nearly cycled into someone.

Dave eventually decided to stop at the (16) for a

brief visit.

Dave encountered some of Jersey's (17) during

his tour.

Dave discovered that there were more (18)

on Jersey than he'd thought.



Part 3

You will hear five short extracts in which people are talking about their university experience away from home. For questions **19–23**, choose from the list (**A–H**) what each speaker regrets about the experience. Use the letters only once. There are three extra letters which you do not need to use.



A not getting to know the local area

B not managing their time well

Speaker 1

	19
--	-----------

C not keeping in touch with family

Speaker 2

	20
--	-----------

D not trying hard enough to make friends

Speaker 3

	21
--	-----------

E not spending money wisely

Speaker 4

	22
--	-----------

F not knowing how to live independently

Speaker 5

	23
--	-----------

G not using helpful information provided

H not being able to focus fully on the course

Test 2

Part 4

You will hear an interview with a tree surgeon called Andrew Smith, who carries out work on trees to make sure they're healthy and safe. For questions **24–30**, choose the best answer (**A**, **B** or **C**).



Listening test audio

- 24** Andrew says he started to work as a tree surgeon because
- A** he was very interested in wildlife.
 - B** his family was keen for him to do it.
 - C** it meant he could spend more time outdoors.
- 25** What surprised Andrew about his first experience of cutting down a tree?
- A** how hard it was to use some of the equipment correctly
 - B** how satisfying it turned out to be for him
 - C** how tired it made him feel
- 26** Andrew wishes he was more like his father in his ability to
- A** remain calm in difficult situations.
 - B** make appropriate decisions.
 - C** pay attention to detail.
- 27** Recently, one of Andrew's clients gave positive feedback about
- A** how quickly the job was completed.
 - B** how clearly he communicated.
 - C** how knowledgeable he was.
- 28** What does Andrew like most about his job?
- A** being part of a team
 - B** having the opportunity to keep learning
 - C** doing something useful for the local community

- 29** Andrew says the worst part of his job is having to
- A** work in bad weather.
 - B** deal with paperwork.
 - C** tidy things up.
- 30** Andrew needs to think seriously about the future because
- A** he wants to be able to make more money.
 - B** he can only do his current work for a limited time.
 - C** he believes environmental policies will affect what he does.